A Mosaic, Not a Melting Pot (Canada)

Target Audience: B1+ / B2
Time: 45-50 minutes
Approach: CLIL + Socio-cultural approach

Lesson Objectives:

- Educational: Understand the history and principles of the Canadian Multiculturalism Act (1988).
- Linguistic: Practice vocabulary related to law, society, and diversity (e.g., *act, policy, diversity, heritage, to pass a law*).
- Socio-cultural: Develop cultural tolerance by analyzing Canada's "mosaic" model and comparing it with the students' home country's approach to diversity (Dialogue of Cultures).

Stage	Stage aim	Timing	Procedure	Aids and materials
Warm-up	Activate background knowledge and introduce the concept of multiculturalism.	5 min	Teacher shows the Canadian flag and asks: *"What do you know about Canada? Is it a country of one culture or many?"*Teacher explains the metaphor: A "melting pot" (USA) blends cultures into one. A "mosaic" (Canada) keeps the pieces separate but together.	Canadian flag, board
Controlled Practice	Pre-teach vocabulary for the video.	7 min	Match words with definitions: *act (law), diversity, heritage, policy, to pass a law.*	Presentation slide
Viewing	Develop listening skills for specific historical facts.	10 min	Students watch the video *"The Multiculturalism Act"*. They answer 4 comprehension questions. *Teacher may pause the video after each section to help B1 students.*	Video (YouTube), Questions The Multicu...

Post-Viewing	Check comprehension and develop critical thinking.	8 min	Teacher checks answers. Discussion: *"Why do you think Canada decided to pass this Act in 1988? What were they trying to achieve?"*	Presentation slide
Freer Practice	Apply knowledge, develop critical thinking through the "Dialogue of Cultures"	15 min	Role-Play "City Committee". Group work. Students are on a city committee in Toronto. They must decide how to spend a $50,000 budget to promote the ideas of the Multiculturalism Act. Options: a bilingual school, a heritage festival, or translation services. Task 2: Dialogue of Cultures. Discuss: *"Does your country have a law like the Multiculturalism Act? Is your country more of a "melting pot" or a "mosaic"?"*	Committee template, board.
Homework and feedback	Summarize and reflect.	5 min	Reflection: *"What are the benefits and challenges of living in a diverse society?"* Homework: Write a short paragraph (50 words): *"Would you like to live in a country with a Multiculturalism Act? Why or why not?"*	Notebooks

Match the words (1-5) with their definitions (A-E).

Word	**Letter**	**Definition**
1. Act (noun)	[ ]	A. The traditions, languages, and culture passed down from generation to generation.

2. Diversity	[ ]	B. A law made by a government.
3. Heritage	[ ]	C. A plan of action agreed by a government or organization.
4. Policy	[ ]	D. The state of having a lot of variety (different people, cultures, ideas).
5. To pass a law	[ ]	E. To officially approve and introduce a new law.

1. B
2. D
3. A
4. C
5. E

Watch the video *"The Multiculturalism Act: How Canada Became a Nation of Diversity"* and answer the questions.

1. What year did Canada pass the Multiculturalism Act?

   _____

2. According to the video, what is the main goal of this Act? (What does it allow people to do?)

   _____

3. _____
4. The video mentions that Canada is a "mosaic", not a "melting pot". What does this mean?

   _____

5. _____
6. True or False: The Multiculturalism Act forces immigrants to forget their original culture.

Multicultural Committee

Situation: You are on the City Committee of Toronto. The city has a budget of $50,000 to promote the ideas of the Multiculturalism Act. You must choose only ONE project to fund.

Options:

1. Bilingual School Program: Free French-English classes for immigrant children.
2. Heritage Festival: A big street party where every community shares its traditional food, music, and clothes.
3. Translation Services: A free app and hotline to help immigrants communicate with doctors and police.

Our Choice: _____

Why we chose this project (3 reasons):

Dialogue of Cultures (Discussion)

Discuss the questions in pairs or small groups:

1. Does your country have a law like the Multiculturalism Act?
2. Is your country more of a "melting pot" or a "mosaic"?
3. What are the benefits and challenges of living in a diverse society?